Emotion before facts

Combined visual guide

Core move

- Acknowledge emotional impact before facts, correction, explanation or details.
- Accuracy stays; the order changes.

Formula

- Feeling signal -> brief validation -> bridge -> facts/details/next step.
- Use "and" or "the detail is," not a dismissive "but."

Minimum move

- That sounds frustrating. The detail I want to check is...
- One human sentence before the factual sentence.

Use when

- The person is upset and facts also matter.
- A correction would sound cold if delivered first.

Avoid when

- Immediate safety facts must come first.
- The person explicitly asks for data first.

Recovery

- I jumped to the facts too fast. Let me back up.
- I may have named that wrong; what is the feeling closer to?

Perception

- Strong feeling words, absolutes, fast pace, shutdown, sarcasm or repeated complaint.
- Your correction reflex switches on.

Move

- Pause before explaining.
- Make one sincere acknowledgement of emotional impact.

Phrase

- That sounds heavy. I want to acknowledge that first.
- I can see why that landed badly. The factual piece is...

Calibration

- Continue if they settle, confirm, or add nuance.
- Adjust if they correct the label or ask for facts.

Neighbour distinction

- TC006 names the emotion; TC098 orders the response.
- TC005 validates without agreement; TC098 prevents facts from sounding dismissive.

Common mistake

- Do not use empathy as a wrapper for immediate correction.
- Do not agree to inaccurate facts to sound kind.